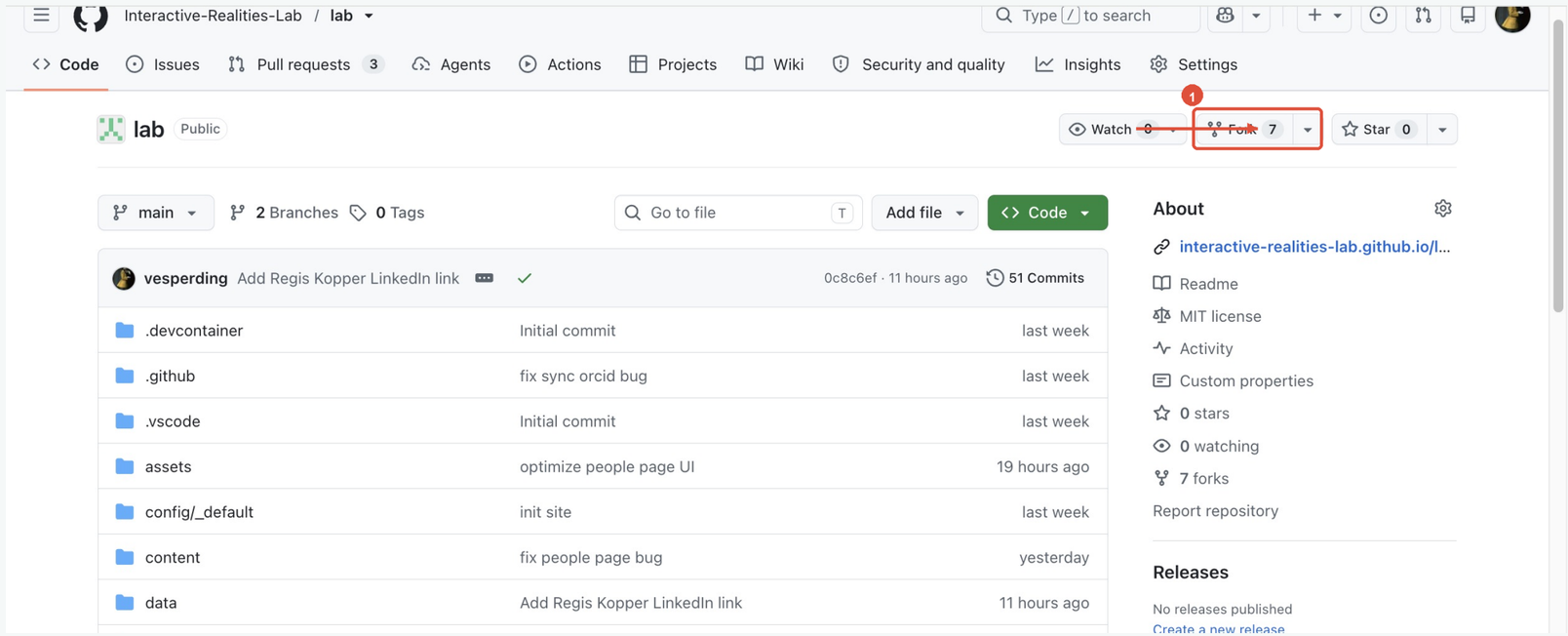
01 Open the lab repository



WHERE

GitHub, signed in.

CLICK

Open github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab and click Fork.

EXPECT

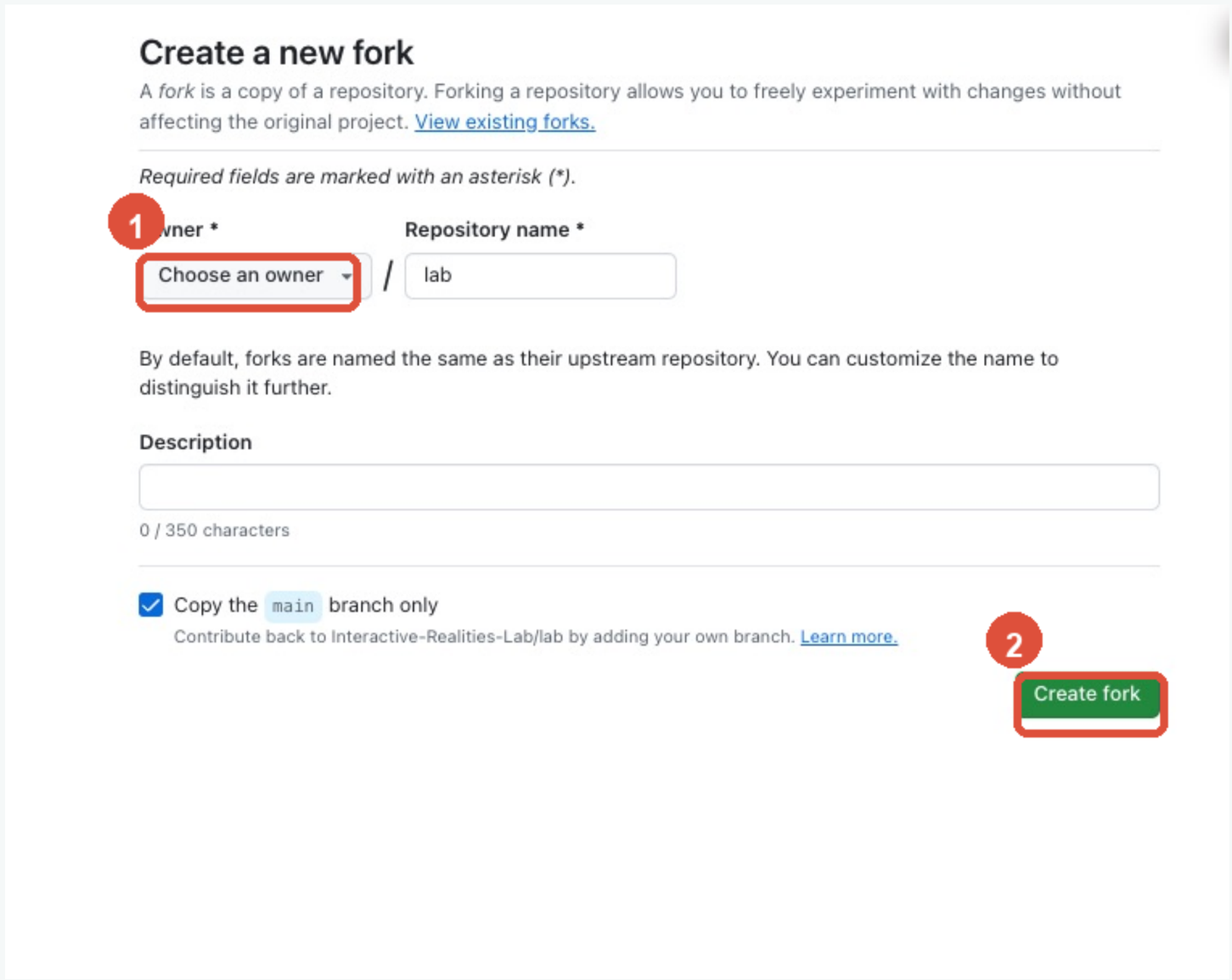
The repository owner is Interactive-Realities-Lab. Fork creation opens.

New fork: follow steps 1-2. Existing fork: go to step 3. Example owner: vesperding; example member: Tanim Ahmed. Use YOUR-USERNAME and your own member folder.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

02 Create your fork once



WHERE

Create a new fork.

CLICK

Choose YOUR-USERNAME as Owner, retain lab, then Create fork.

EXPECT

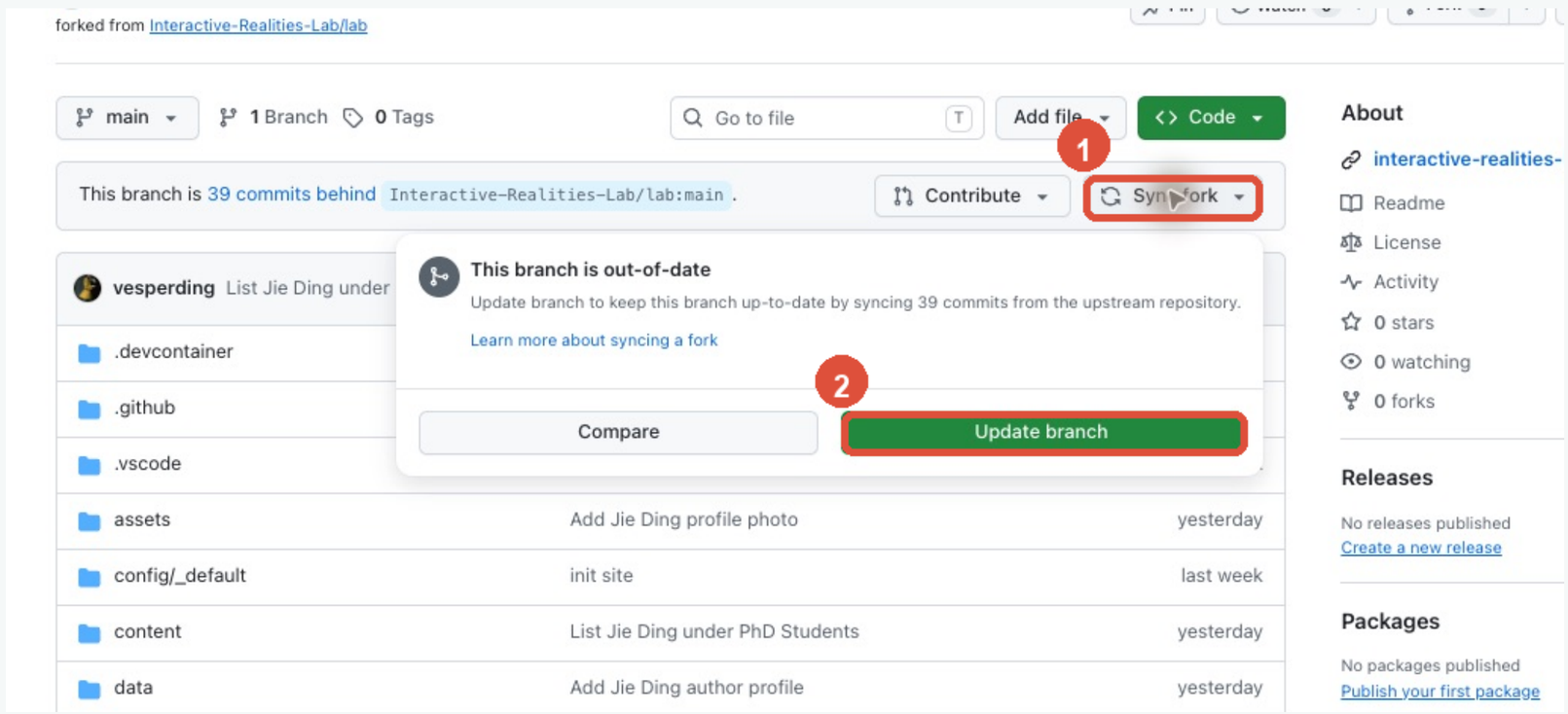
Your repository is YOUR-USERNAME/lab.

A fork is your own editable copy; it does not publish the website.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

03 Sync an existing fork before editing



WHERE

YOUR-USERNAME/lab, main.

CLICK

Existing fork with no open PR: Sync fork, then Update branch. Do this first if submissions/ or your profile is missing.

EXPECT

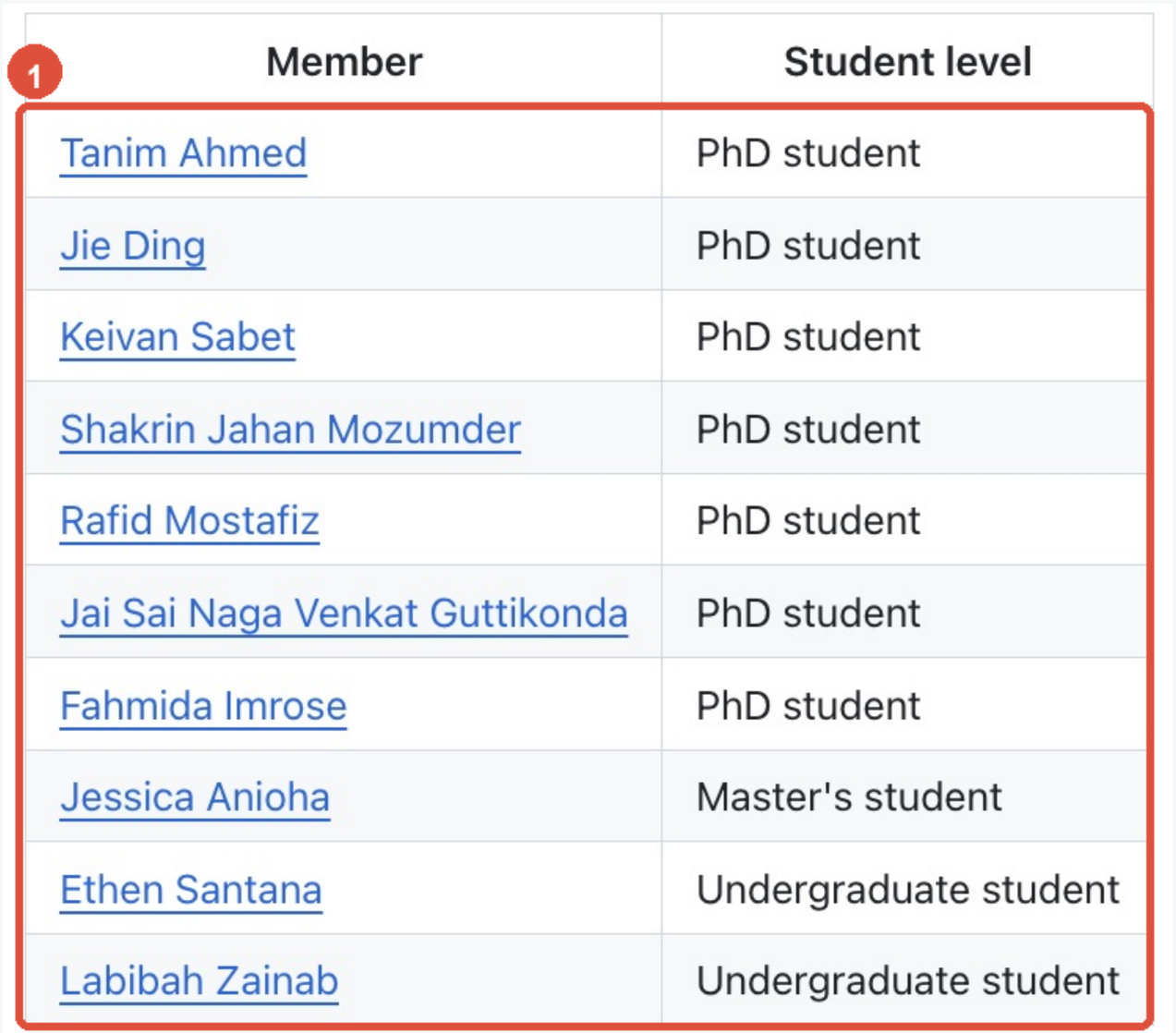
Your main is up to date with the lab main.

This applies on your first use of this guide and after a prior PR is merged. If a PR is open, continue its same source branch; do not open another. If sync conflicts, keep your work and ask a maintainer.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

04 Find your own member folder



WHERE

Your fork on main: submissions/README.md.

CLICK

Use the member table to find your profile. Open your own member folder.

EXPECT

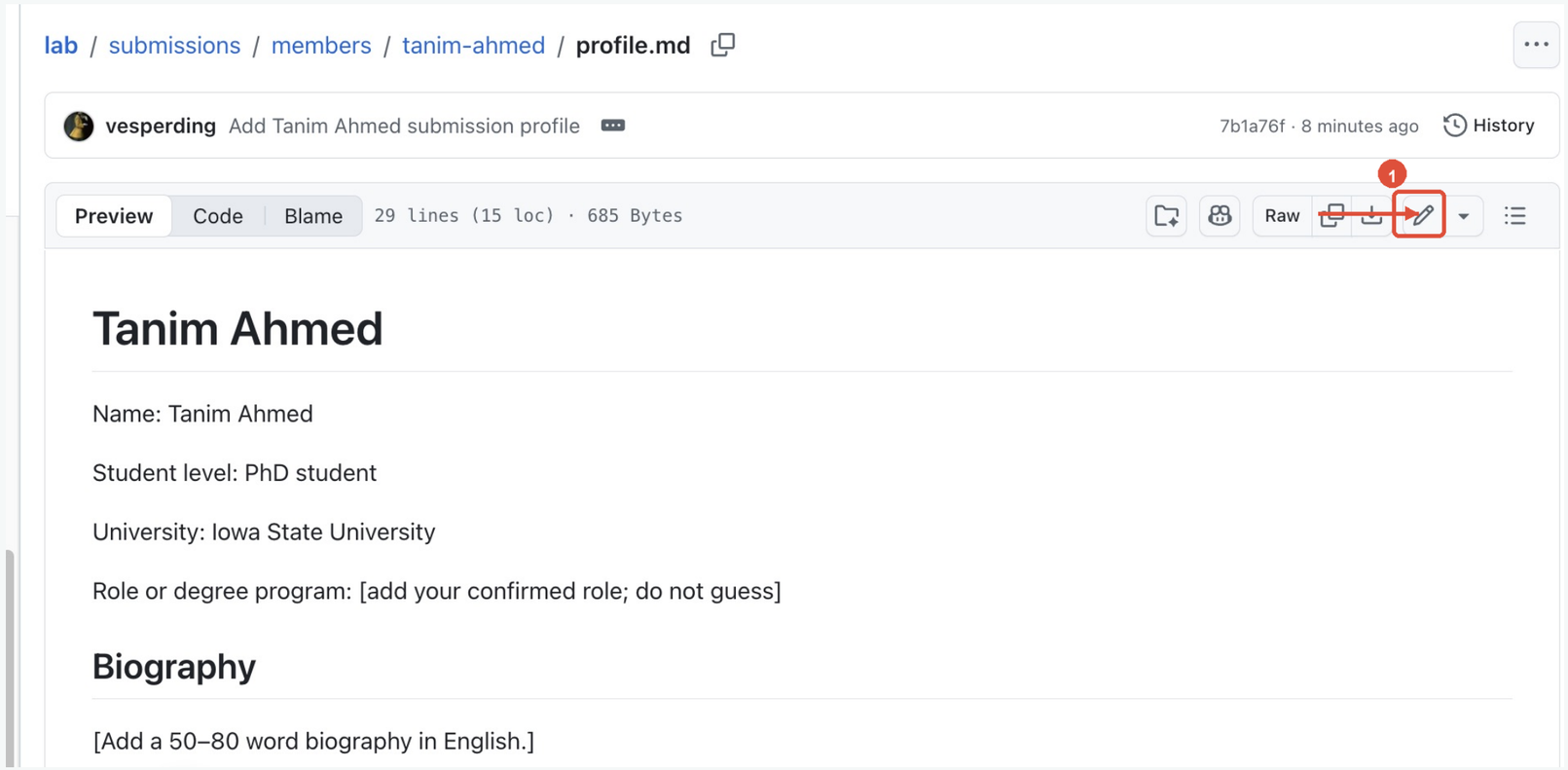
You see submissions/members/YOUR-FOLDER/profile.md.

Tanim Ahmed is the example member in the screenshots. Use your own name and folder; all ten profiles already exist.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

05 Open your existing profile



WHERE

Your fork on main: submissions/members/YOUR-FOLDER/profile.md.

CLICK

Open your member folder and profile.md; click the pencil icon.

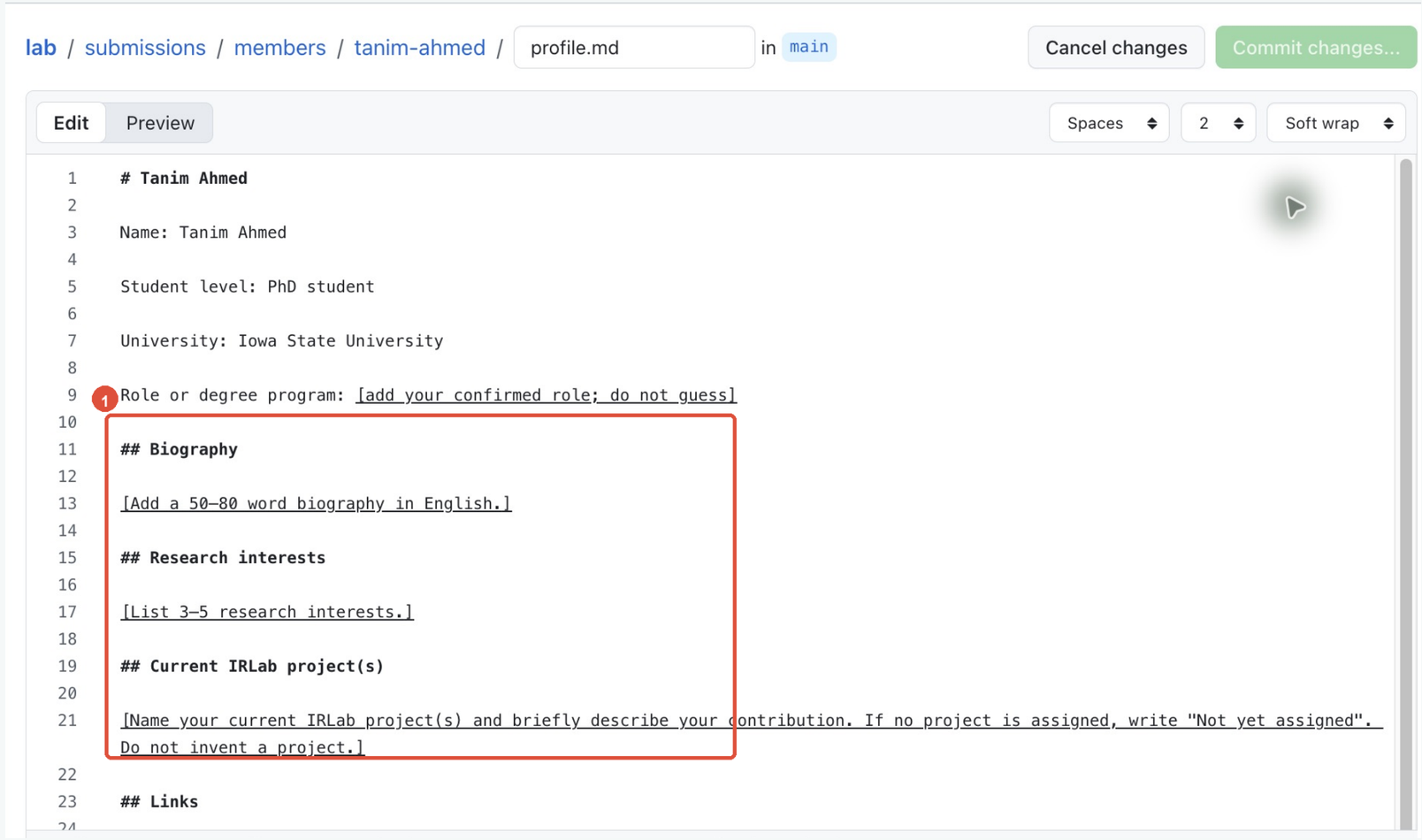
EXPECT

The profile editor opens in your own fork.

All ten member folders already exist. Edit the same profile.md every time.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

06 Write your profile



WHERE

The profile.md editor.

CLICK

Write a 50-80 word English bio, 3-5 interests, and current IRLab project(s) plus your contribution.

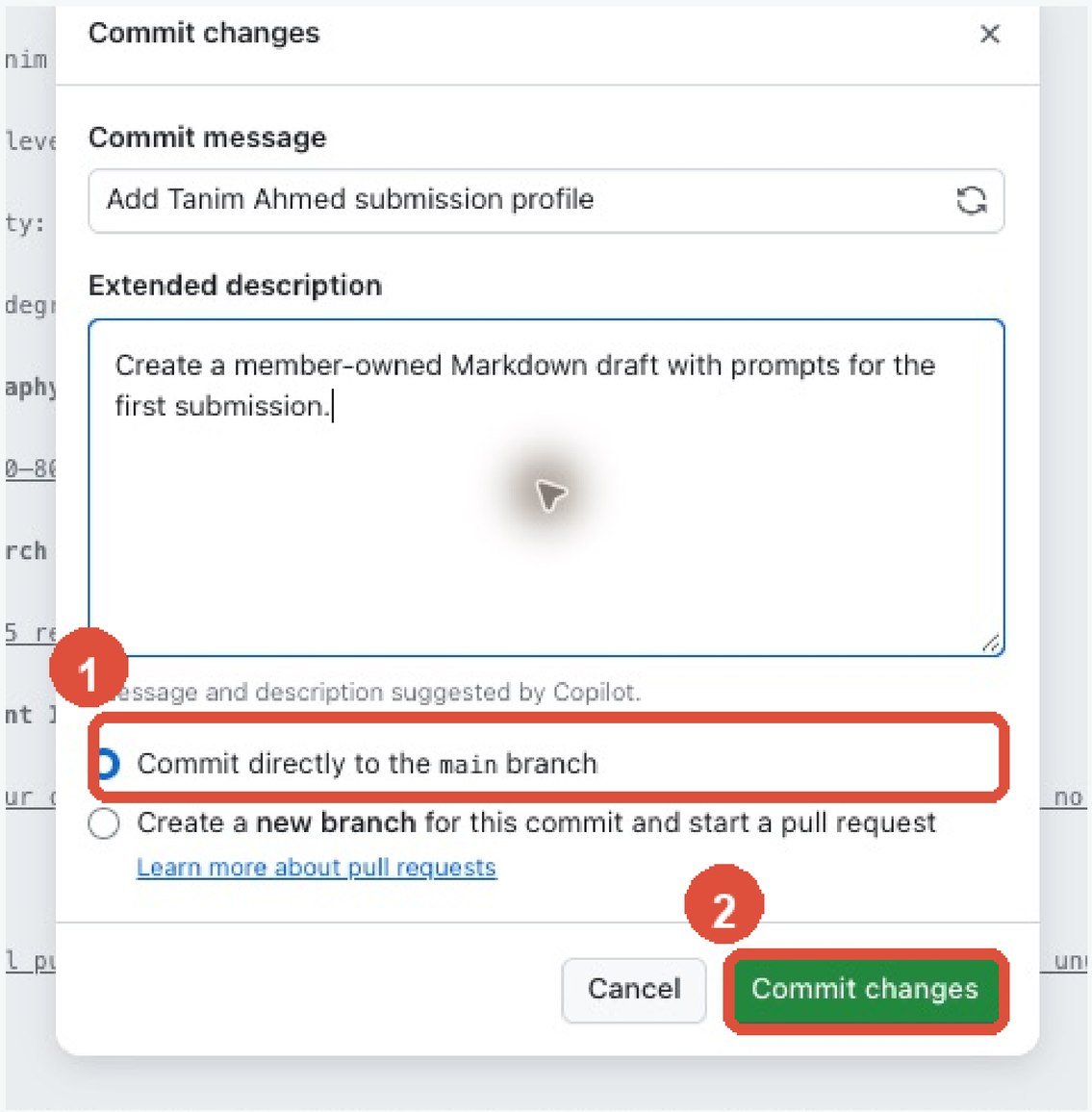
EXPECT

The proposed text contains confirmed facts.

The screenshot still contains prompts: replace them all before committing. Commit changes becomes active after an edit. If no project is assigned, write Not yet assigned. First profiles require a photo; replacements are optional for the three already published profiles.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

07 Commit the profile edit



WHERE

The file editor, Commit changes dialog.

CLICK

Commit changes; describe the edit; Commit directly to main; Commit changes.

EXPECT

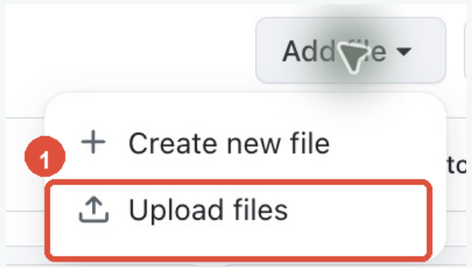
Your updated profile appears in your fork.

Repeat this commit step after every file edit. A commit saves a change in your fork.

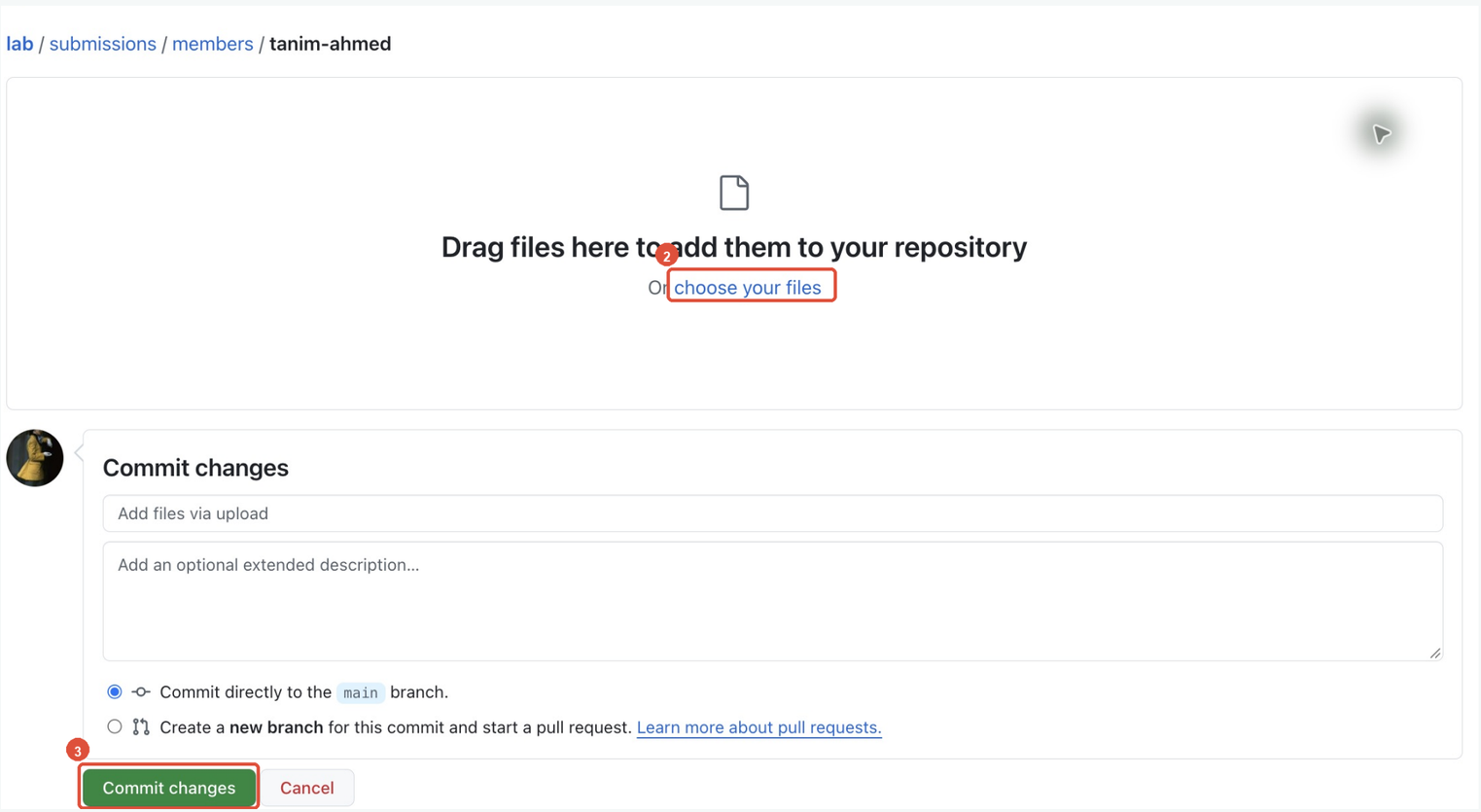
Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

08 Upload your photo



Add file > Upload files



WHERE

Your member folder on main.

CLICK

Add file > Upload files; select or drag the photo; Commit changes.

EXPECT

The photo appears beside profile.md.

Keep its real .jpg, .png, or .webp extension. No conversion is required. Screenshot is before selecting a file; choose yours first.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

09 Connect the photo to your profile



WHERE

Your profile.md editor.

CLICK

Enter the relative filename, such as portrait.jpg; Commit changes.

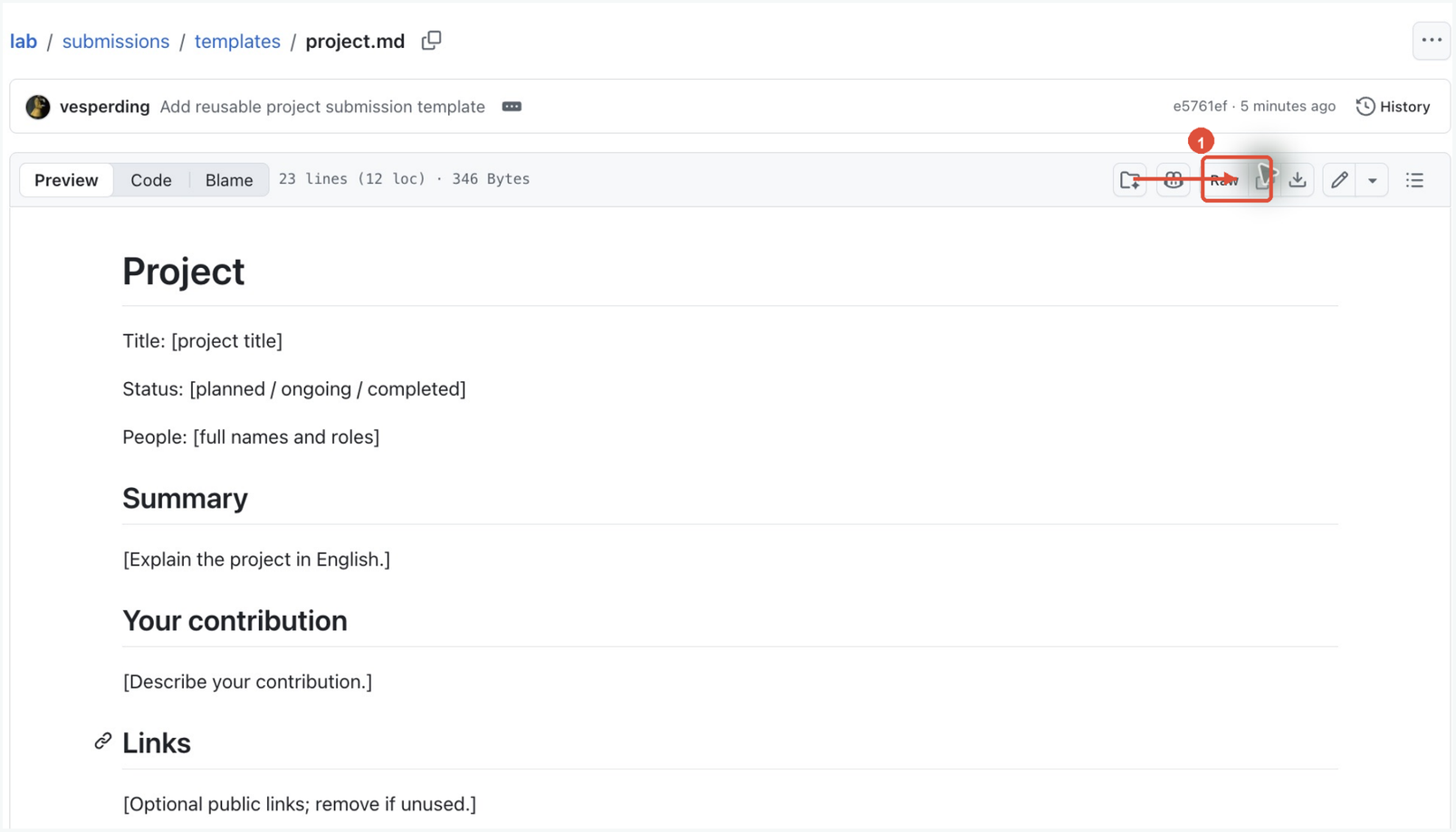
EXPECT

Your profile names the uploaded photo.

This screenshot demonstrates portrait.jpg in an unsaved editor. Enter your actual uploaded filename and commit. Replace all remaining prompts before committing.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

10 Copy the right content template



WHERE

submissions/templates/project.md, publication.md, or news.md.

CLICK

Open the template, click Raw, and copy the plain Markdown.

EXPECT

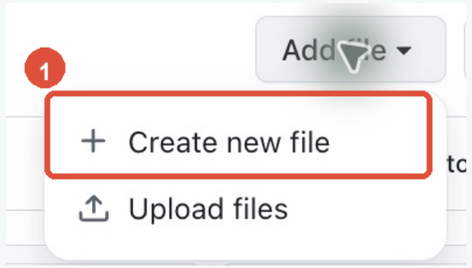
You have the template text ready to paste.

For profiles, keep using your existing profile.md. Projects/publications/news are optional when you have material to submit.

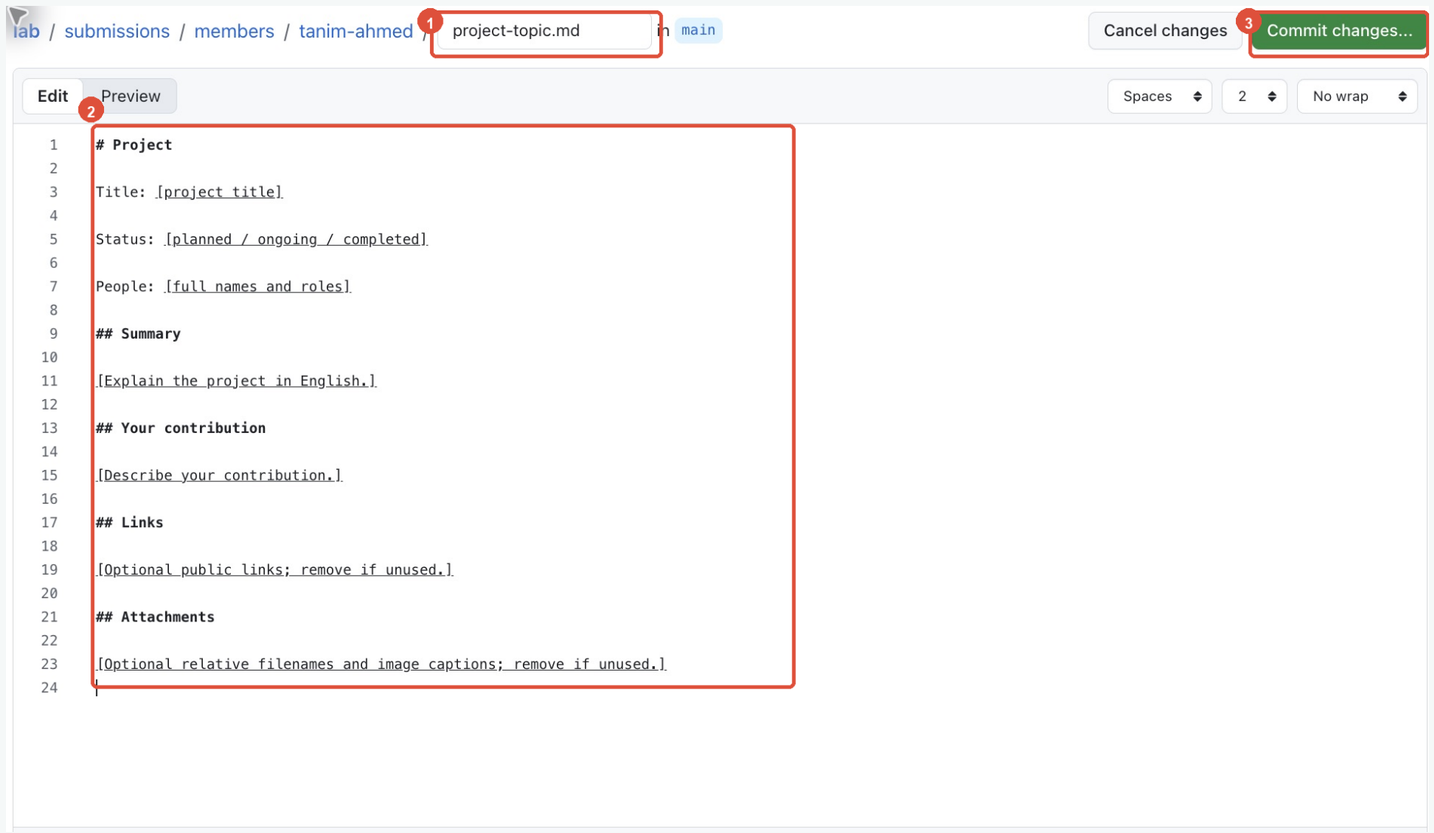
Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

11 Create the topic file



Add file > Create new file



WHERE

Your member folder in YOUR-USERNAME/lab on main.

CLICK

Add file > Create new file; name project-topic.md, publication-topic.md, or news-topic.md; paste and complete the template.

EXPECT

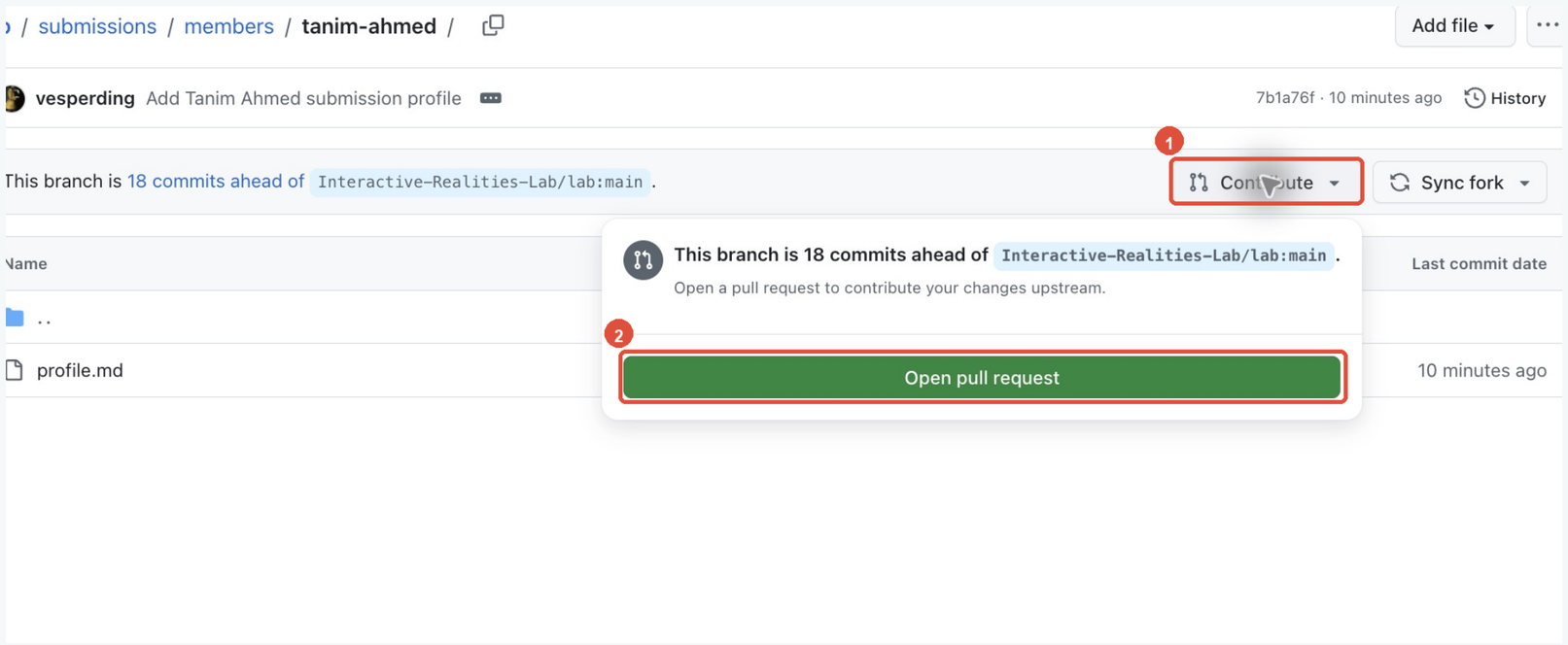
The editor contains your new topic file.

Screenshot shows an unsaved template example. Replace every prompt before Commit changes to main. Verify publication status: unpublished draft, preprint, accepted, or published; keep not yet confirmed if unknown.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

12 Start one pull request



WHERE

Your fork repository, all files committed.

CLICK

Contribute > Open pull request, or Compare & pull request.

EXPECT

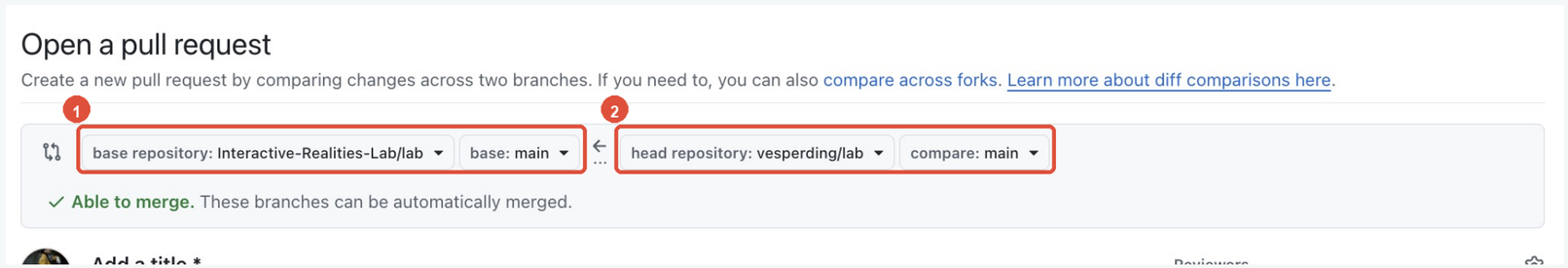
GitHub opens the comparison page.

Put all related edits and uploads into one request. An open request receives later commits from the same source branch automatically.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

13 Check the comparison



WHERE

The GitHub comparison page.

CLICK

Verify base: Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab, main; head: YOUR-USERNAME/lab, main. Review Files changed below the form.

EXPECT

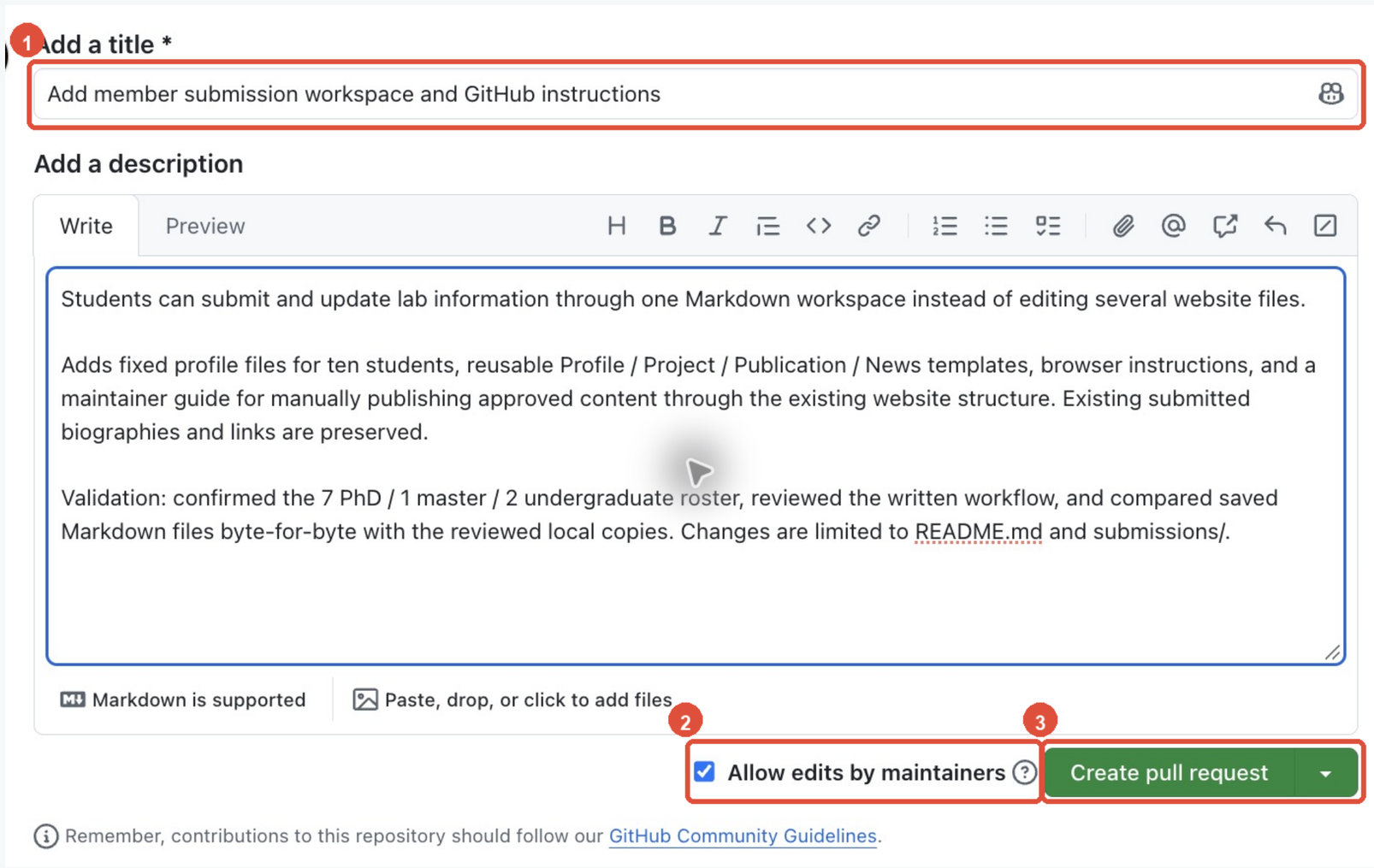
Only your intended changes are included.

The form may already be visible, as here. If you see a comparison-only page, click Create pull request to open it. Base is the lab destination; head is your own fork.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

14 Create the pull request



WHERE

The pull request form.

CLICK

Write a clear title and short description. Keep Allow edits by maintainers checked if offered; Create pull request.

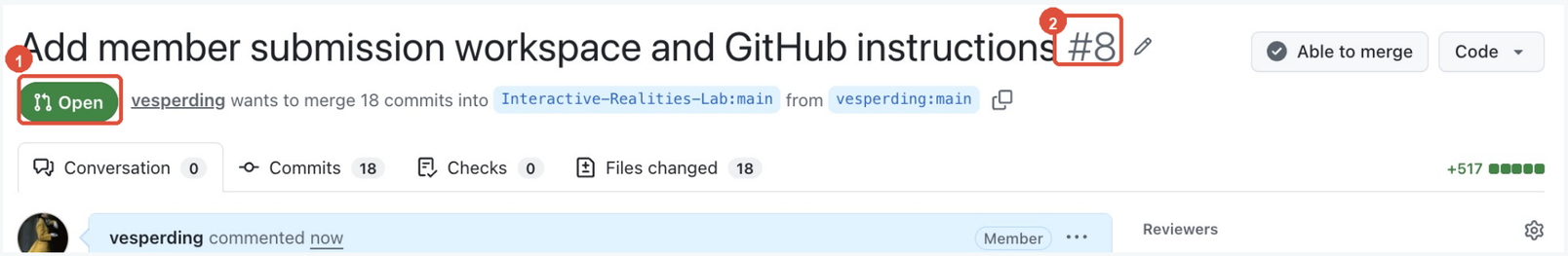
EXPECT

Your request has been sent for review.

This capture shows the maintainer setup request. For your submission, use your own name and purpose, e.g. Update Tanim Ahmed profile. Commit any corrections on the same source branch.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

15 You are done when the request is Open



WHERE

The new pull request page.

CLICK

Check the Open label and PR number.

EXPECT

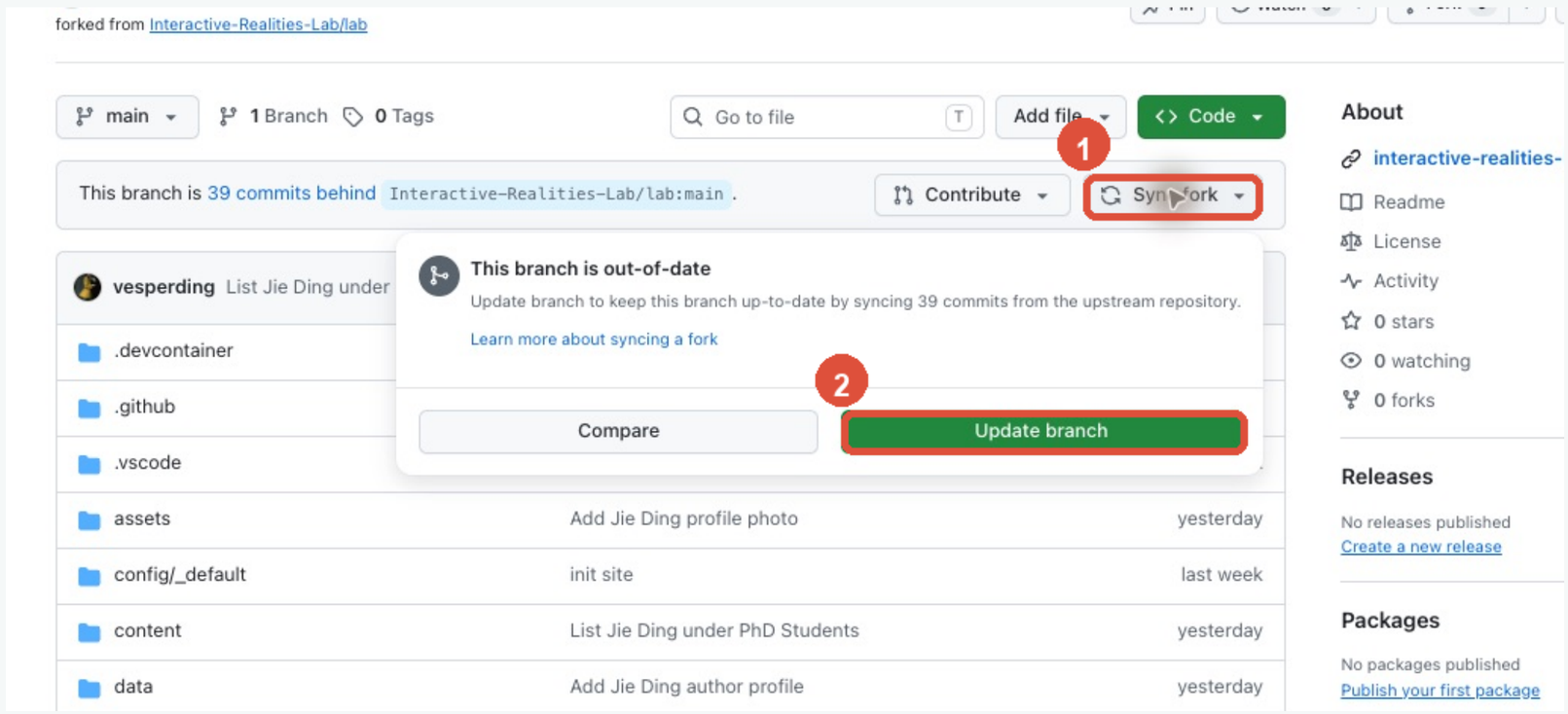
Open pull request #... confirms your submission.

The screenshot shows example PR #8. Your own request will have its own number. Wait for review; do not click Merge. Maintainers manually publish approved content.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.

16 Later updates use the same files



WHERE

Your fork and the previous request.

CLICK

If the request is open: edit and commit on its same source branch. After it is merged: sync main before a new request.

EXPECT

Open requests update automatically; later merged work starts from a synced fork.

Never discard unsynced work to fix a conflict. Ask a maintainer. Check the page owner is YOUR-USERNAME before every edit.

Start: https://github.com/Interactive-Realities-Lab/lab

Screenshots show an example account. Use YOUR-USERNAME for your own fork.